

Lady D KDP Trim and Cover Readiness Worksheet

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Purpose: prepare the next print-production phase for the three Lady D devotional volumes and their companion journals.

Current Assumptions

- Format target: Amazon KDP paperback, 6 x 9 in trim.
- Interior target: black ink paperback. White-paper and cream-paper spine calculations are both shown because the final paper choice is not locked yet.
- Interior review PDFs are current assembly outputs, not final KDP interiors. Page counts may change after front matter, back matter, typography, margins, and final copyedit design passes.
- Cover dimensions below use the official KDP paperback cover formula: bleed + back cover width + spine width + front cover width + bleed.
- For 6 x 9 covers with bleed, height is 9.25 in and width is 12.25 in plus spine width.
- All titles currently exceed 79 pages, so spine text is allowed, but it still needs KDP spine safe-area spacing.

Official KDP Sources Used

- [Create a Paperback Cover - Amazon KDP](#)
- [Set Trim Size, Bleed, and Margins - Amazon KDP](#)
- [Paperback Submission Guidelines - Amazon KDP](#)

KDP Formula Summary

- Cover width = $0.125 + \text{back cover width} + \text{spine width} + \text{front cover width} + 0.125$.
- Cover height = $0.125 + \text{trim height} + 0.125$.
- 6 x 9 full-wrap cover height with bleed: 9.25 in.
- 6 x 9 full-wrap cover width before spine: 12.25 in.
- Black-and-white white-paper spine width: $\text{page count} \times 0.002252$ in.
- Black-and-white cream-paper spine width: $\text{page count} \times 0.0025$ in.

- 6 x 9 interior page size without bleed: 6 x 9 in.
- 6 x 9 interior page size with bleed: 6.125 x 9.25 in.

Current Cover Size Matrix

Artifact	Title	Pages	White- paper spine	White- paper cover size	Cream- paper spine	Cream- paper cover size
Volume 1 manuscript	Surrendering to God's Love	409	0.921 in	13.171 x 9.250 in	1.022 in	13.273 x 9.250 in
Volume 2 manuscript	Walking with Jesus	350	0.788 in	13.038 x 9.250 in	0.875 in	13.125 x 9.250 in
Volume 3 manuscript	Filled with the Holy Spirit	339	0.763 in	13.013 x 9.250 in	0.848 in	13.098 x 9.250 in
Volume 1 journal	Surrendering to God's Love Companion Journal	94	0.212 in	12.462 x 9.250 in	0.235 in	12.485 x 9.250 in
Volume 2 journal	Walking with Jesus Companion Journal	81	0.182 in	12.432 x 9.250 in	0.203 in	12.453 x 9.250 in
Volume 3 journal	Filled with the Holy Spirit	90	0.203 in	12.453 x 9.250 in	0.225 in	12.475 x 9.250 in

Artifact	Title	Pages	White- paper spine	White- paper cover size	Cream- paper spine	Cream- paper cover size
	Companion Journal					

Minimum Margin Matrix

Artifact	Pages	KDP band	Inside/gutter minimum	Outside minimum no bleed	Outside minimum with bleed
Volume 1 manuscript	409	301-500 pages	0.625 in	0.25 in	0.375 in
Volume 2 manuscript	350	301-500 pages	0.625 in	0.25 in	0.375 in
Volume 3 manuscript	339	301-500 pages	0.625 in	0.25 in	0.375 in
Volume 1 journal	94	24-150 pages	0.375 in	0.25 in	0.375 in
Volume 2 journal	81	24-150 pages	0.375 in	0.25 in	0.375 in
Volume 3 journal	90	24-150 pages	0.375 in	0.25 in	0.375 in

Recommended Interior Path

1. Build final 6 x 9 interior templates for each manuscript and companion journal.
2. Use no-bleed interiors unless a later design pass intentionally adds edge-to-edge art.
3. Apply mirrored margins and the KDP minimum gutter by page-count band.

4. Add front matter, copyright, dedication, series page, author note, permissions note, and closing pages before locking page count.
5. Re-export final PDF interiors and rerun page-count extraction.
6. Recalculate full-wrap cover dimensions from the final page count and selected paper type.

Recommended Cover Path

1. Pick a visual route from the nine-cover board: Path, Modern Sacred Minimal, Sanctuary, or a hybrid route.
2. Decide paper type for each book: white paper for brighter covers and modern contrast, or cream paper for warmer devotional feel and slightly thicker spine.
3. Use the chosen final page count and paper type in the official KDP cover calculator before export.
4. Build a full-wrap PDF cover with back cover, spine, and front cover as one image/PDF.
5. Keep front/back text at least 0.125 in inside trim lines and keep spine text at least 0.0625 in from spine edges.
6. Avoid hard vertical color breaks at the spine because KDP allows binding/trim variance.
7. Export print cover art at 300 DPI, flattened, with fonts embedded or outlined in the production PDF.

Next Gate

The project is ready for a trim-specific KDP design pass, but not a final KDP upload yet. The final upload package should not be declared ready until each book has a locked paper type, final designed page count, print-ready interior PDF, print-ready full-wrap cover PDF, and fresh KDP previewer pass.